6.7 Automating scenarios in .NET with SpecFlow

If you're in a .NET environment, your best option for BDD is SpecFlow (http://specflow.org). SpecFlow is an open source Visual Studio extension that provides support for Gherkin scenarios in the .NET and Windows development ecosystem. The rest of this section will assume that you're reasonably familiar with the Visual Studio development environment.

6.7.1 Setting up SpecFlow

SpecFlow is a Visual Studio extension, so you can install it directly from the Visual Studio Gallery (see figure 6.9). Once it's installed, you'll need to create a new Unit Test project in Visual Studio and add the SpecFlow package to your project using NuGet (the .NET package manager found at http://www.nuget.org/).

SpecFlow works with several .NET unit testing frameworks, including NUnit, xUnit, and a more specialized commercial tool called SpecRun. In this example, we'll be using NUnit.

You can install SpecFlow with NUnit through the Manage NuGet Packages screen or directly from the NuGet Package Management Console using the following command:

```
PM> Install-Package SpecFlow.NUnit
```

6.7.2 Adding feature files

SpecFlow uses Gherkin feature files like the ones used by Cucumber and Behave. Once SpecFlow is installed, you can add a new item to your project and choose SpecFlow Feature File. This will open a new feature file in the SpecFlow editor (see figure 6.10).

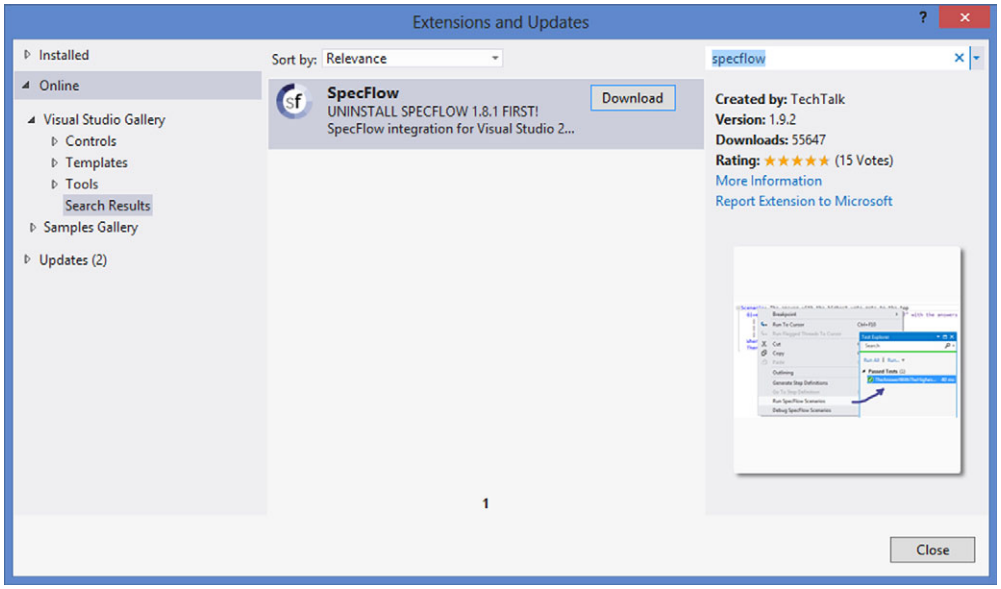


Figure 6.9 You can install SpecFlow in the Visual Studio Gallery.